



5G net neutrality

Net Neutrality may strike some chords with Facebook but Tom Wheeler narrates a different story of why 5G needs to be neutral <http://dgit.in/5GNeutral>



Intel NUC upgraded

Intel also launched its new upgraded NUC to combat the likes of Gigabyte's Brix. Read on to find out how good is it. <http://dgit.in/IrisNUC>

Bazaar

Microsoft Surface Pro 4

Replacing your laptop, and bank balance

Microsoft has been wanting to replace your laptop with its tablet device for a few years now. But while they came close to doing so in the past, the Surface Pro 4 is the closest they've ever come to it. And some say that with this particular device, the Redmond giant may well have achieved the impossible. But alas, it's too expensive to recommend and the battery life is just not enough to fulfill Microsoft's dreams. Nevertheless, it's hard to deny the Surface Pro 4 is the best tablet in the market today.

The kickstand remains its most important design feature, and the Surface Pro 4 is lighter than ultrabooks like the Dell XPS 13. It weighs 786 grams, plus a few more for the Typecover case and can be placed at angles between 22 and 150 degrees. Needless to say, it suits almost all positions that you would ever need. If Microsoft can somehow figure out how to stop the device from wobbling in your lap, it would perhaps have perfected the design. It's still a much better designed tablet than the Apple iPad Pro, hands down.

Further, the fact that the Microsoft Surface Pro 4's 2736x1824 pixel resolution achieves a pixel density of 267 ppi on the 12.3 inch display. To say that the Surface Pro 4 has a 'nice' display would be a massive understatement. There are few ultrabooks that can rival this display, and amongst tablets, only the iPad Pro comes to mind.

The Surface Pen takes a bit of getting used to, but for animators and graphic artists, this does the job admirably. The fact that it attaches magnetically to the left side of the tablet makes it easy to carry around, and it sticks even when you're carrying the tablet around in your bag. You never realise what 1024 levels of pressure means until you have the Surface Pen in your hand. It's a joy to behold and a great input tool to work with.

None of this makes the Surface Pro 4 a true laptop replacement though. That job is undertaken by the Typecover keyboard, which Microsoft refuses to include in the box, thereby adding to the overall price. The Typecover keyboard has the perfect pitch to ensure that there is no learning curve. While the slight wobble can be an issue for some, the travel and feedback more than make up for it. Microsoft has even been able to make it backlit. As mentioned above though, it isn't included in the price, and it costs ₹12,490. This brings the starting price of the Surface Pro 4, a whopping ₹1,02,480!



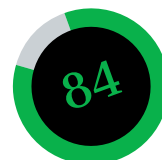
Speaking of which, the lowest end Surface Pro 4 comes with 4GB of RAM and the Intel i5-6300U processor. Games like Asphalt 8 run like a breeze on the device and it shows better benchmark scores than laptops like the HP Spectre x360, and goes toe to toe with the most high-end laptops in the market today.

All that firepower takes a toll on the 5087 mAh battery though. The Surface Pro 4 can last through about 4 hours of constant video viewing (at 720p) and just a little longer when editing documents (with the screen brightness turned to maximum). You will have to carry the charger around with you usually.

To sum up, the Microsoft Surface Pro 4, for the most part, can indeed replace your laptop. However, the four hour battery life just doesn't cut it for a tablet that wants to be your only laptop. In addition, not including the Typecover case in the device's cost is perhaps the worst decision Microsoft has ever made, making its best device very difficult to recommend to the average buyer. Even for enterprises, the ₹1 lakh plus price tag seems too steep, especially in India.

So, while the Microsoft Surface Pro 4 is indeed the best tablet in the market today, beating the iPad Pro by miles, Microsoft still needs to work out the kinks if it really wants to sell this device, especially in a price sensitive market like India. Having said that, it'll be interesting to see if the Huawei Matebook comes at a more affordable price point in India, and whether it is powerful enough to justify spending money on it. Only time will tell. For now, all you have is the Microsoft Surface Pro 4.

Prasid Banerjee



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Design	94
Value	64

Specifications

Processor: 2.5Ghz Intel i5-6300U processor; **RAM:** 4GB; **Operating System:** Windows 10; **Thickness:** 8.45mm; **Weight:** 786 grams; **Battery:** 5087 mAh

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